

SUNDAY 6 SEPTEMBER 2026

Twenty Third Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:

Aghyaran ♦ Ardstraw West & Castlederg ♦ Drumquin

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Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393

Parish websites (*including access to church webcams*) and emails:

Aghyaran: Website: parishofaghyaran.com Email: aghyaranparish@derrydiocese.org

Drumquin: Website: drumquinparish.com Email: drumquin@derrydiocese.org

Ardstraw West & Castlederg: Web: castledergparish.com Email: castledergparish@derrydiocese.org

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:

Ms Marie O'Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 7 Sept		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 8 Sept	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 9 Sept	Liturgy of the Word, With Holy Communion	Liturgy of the Word, With Holy Communion	Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 10 Sept	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon		
Friday 11 Sept		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon	
Saturday 12 Sept	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 13 Sept	<i>Mass on first and third Sunday</i>	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am Drumnabey, 12.30pm	<i>Mass on first and third Sunday</i>

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £877 & €51. **Church Restoration Fund:** £773 & €522.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,018 & €79, made up of:

Castlederg £1,147 & €46, **Drumnabey** £483 & €36, **Dregish** £388 & €10. **DRUMQUIN:** £877.

UNLOCKING THE MYSTERIES OF THE BIBLE: As published last week, we had intended to start this eight-week course in the coming week. Unfortunately, the resources that we need for the programme will not be available until the end of September. We will keep you posted with a new start-date as soon as we have the materials. Apologies for the inconvenience.



We pray for the happy repose of the soul of Evelyn Baxter, Castlefin Park, whose Funeral Mass took place in Castlederg on Thursday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to Evelyn's family and to all who mourn her death. May she rest in peace.

CONGRATULATIONS to the winners in the Ardstraw West and Castlederg Monthly Draw for Parish Development, which took place in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, on Sunday 30 August:

£1,000 Eunan Carlin (1118) Promoter's Prize: Sylvia McHugh
£500 Lynn Gallen (13)
£250 (x 3) May Browne (16); Michael Lynch (677); Alicia McCrory (220)
£100 (x 7) Mary McGlinchey (918); Eugene Carlin (557); Michael Gallen (194); Frank & Geraldine Gallen (1027); Patrick McHugh (600); Michelle McDougall (832); Fr Patsy Arkinson (678).

As always, thanks to our wonderful team of promoters and to all who are supporting our Parish Appeal by taking part in the draw. Returns for September's draw should be made to the Parochial House on Thursday 17 September between 6.00 and 7.30pm. The next draw will take place on Sunday 27 September 2026 in St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg.

There is a small number of tickets left – if you are not in the draw but would like to join, talk to the promoter in your area or contact Kathleen in the Parish Office. If you're not in, you can't win!

PASTORAL VISITATION OF THE HOUSEBOUND will take place this week as follows:

Monday 7 Sept – Drumquin - Rural Area only: Tattysallagh Road / Dooish Road / Glen Road / Bradan Road / Sloughan Road / Drumscrew Road, commencing at 11.00am - Fr Thomas.

Wednesday 9 Sept – Castlederg Rural Area, Oakleigh Grove, Main Street and Derg Fold, commencing at 3.00pm - Fr Thomas.

Thursday 10 Sept – Young Crescent and Drumnabey, commencing at 10.30am – Fr Paul.

Friday 11 Sept – Town Area – (excluding Oakleigh Grove, Derg Fold & Main Street), commencing 10.30am – Fr Paul.

BLESSING OF STUDENTS: A special Mass to mark the beginning of the school year for both Primary and Secondary school pupils will be celebrated on Saturday 12 September at 7.30pm in St. Patrick's Church Aghyaran.

Blessing of school bags for those starting school will take place at this Mass. We encourage families to come along and young children beginning school are asked to bring their school bag with them, as we ask God's blessing on all of them and their work in the new year ahead.

PRAYER:

Lord, we thank you for your goodness to all your children,

Be with these children throughout this new school year.

May your blessing be upon these school bags which the children will carry to and from school each day.

Watch over the children in their coming and their going.

Keep them safe always; help them to be kind; bless their learning and their play.

Enfold them at all times in your love. We pray through Christ our Lord. AMEN

LEGION OF MARY Meetings will resume in Drumquin Parochial House this Thursday, 10 September, commencing at 7.30pm. New members are very welcome to come along to this short time prayer and reflections.

RISE AND SHINE TRUST – Easter 2027 Pilgrimage: Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11-30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with Rise and Shine Trust. The trip is free to Guests. Application form available on riseandshine.ie. Closing date 15 October. Applications also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests. Applications at riseandshine.ie Visit www.riseandshine.ie or contact Sian (07960211352) or Maurice (07711504821).

ARANDERG CCÉ Irish Traditional Music Sessions have started back on Friday nights at 9.00pm in Killeter Heritage. Everyone is welcome! We are holding a **registration night** tomorrow, Mon 7 September, for parents to register their child for upcoming music lessons, in Banjo, Fiddle, Accordion and Tin whistle. Lessons are £30 for 6 weeks, with payment required on registration night. Call in any time between 7.00 – 8.00pm to register or if you have any questions.

IRISH DANCING resumes on **Tuesday 8 September**, at **6.00pm** in **Drumquin Community Youth Centre**. New beginners P1 and above are welcome to join. Text / call Dolores on 07739631478.

ZUMBA FITNESS with Vanessa is back for September – Tuesday 8 September at 7.00pm in Garvagh Hall and Wednesday 9 September at 7.00pm in St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg. No experience needed, no perfect moves required, no pressure. Any questions or queries, contact Vanessa on 077 0235 5424

YOGA CLASS: Aghyaran Development Association in conjunction with HARC is commencing a 6-week Yogo class for over 50's in Aghyaran Centre, commencing Tues 15 September, 11.30am - 12.30pm. Contact Jerry on 078 6492 9344.

HOST FOR HOSPICE: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

Season of Creation 2026: 1 September to 4 October

The annual celebration of Season of Creation aims to bring Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation. The theme is inspired by the vision of hope and renewal found in the Book of Ezekiel, 47:9: "Wherever the river flows, every living creature that swarms will live... and everything will live where the river goes."